

MX Tools: the ultimate (2026) guide to using MX Linux's “secret” tools

incastro.altervista.org/en/mx-tools-guide-mx-linux

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MX Linux is famous because it's **stable, practical and extremely easy to manage**. But the real reason so many people choose it isn't “just” Debian: it's **MX Tools**.

We're talking about a graphical control panel that lets you do in 2 clicks what, on other distros, would require terminal commands, endless guides or scattered applications.

And no: MX Linux isn't “just for Mini PCs.” It works perfectly on **modern PCs**, recent laptops, workstations and powerful machines. It simply gives you **control + stability** without the headache.

What is MX Tools (and why it changes everything)

MX Tools is a graphical suite of utilities that simplifies MX Linux management: software installation, maintenance, drivers, backup/snapshot, boot repair, appearance tweaks and much more.

It's designed both for beginners and for users who want to get things done **quickly and cleanly** without wasting time.

Where to find MX Tools (spoiler: searching “mx tools” doesn’t always work)

On many installations, it doesn’t appear directly when searching for “mx tools” in the menu. The easiest way is:

- Open **Welcome to MX**
- Click the icon or entry that opens **MX Tools**

When you open a tool, the main MX Tools window often hides in the background. When you close the tool, it comes back automatically. That’s normal behavior.

The MX Tools sections: what you actually get

Inside MX Tools you’ll find categories such as:

- **Live** (tools for live USB and snapshot)
- **Maintenance** (cleaning, boot, users, disk, network)
- **Setup** (system configuration, drivers, codecs, audio, tweaks)
- **Software** (repositories, mirrors, packages, keys)
- **Utilities** (system info, USB tools and more)

Not everything is fully translated in every language it depends on your MX version and installed packages.

1) LIVE: create live USBs and clone your system (without fear)

MX Live USB Maker (like Etcher, but integrated)

This tool lets you create a **Live USB** from an ISO file.

- Select your USB drive
- Select the ISO file
- Choose additional options
- Start the creation process

Perfect if you want to test MX Linux on multiple PCs or prepare ready-to-use USB systems.

Snapshot: the most powerful MX Linux feature

MX Snapshot allows you to create a **bootable copy of your entire system** (an ISO of your configured MX installation). It’s useful for:

- Full system backup

- Recovery in case of issues
- Reinstalling the exact same setup on another PC
- Creating a personalized live system with your apps

In short: you can experiment freely, because if something breaks... **you can roll back**.

2) MAINTENANCE: cleaning, boot repair, network and “lifesaver” tools

MX Cleaner: simple and effective cleanup

MX Cleaner helps remove:

- temporary files
- cache
- unnecessary junk

It doesn't perform miracles, but it keeps the system tidy (especially after months of use).

Boot Repair / Boot options: when something won't start

If you have boot issues, MX Tools includes utilities to:

- repair GRUB
- adjust boot parameters and timing
- fix startup issues in a guided way

Chroot Rescue Scan: recovering broken installations

A rescue tool for scanning and recovering installations when the system won't boot properly and you want to avoid a full reinstall.

Disk, users, Samba and scheduling

In the Maintenance section you also find tools for:

- user management
- disk and mount point management
- Samba configuration (local network sharing)
- Job Scheduler (schedule scripts and tasks)

3) SETUP: drivers, codecs, audio, Conky and visual tweaks

This section is often the most feature-rich because it handles many practical system configurations.

NVIDIA drivers (guided installation)

If you have an NVIDIA GPU, there's a tool that downloads and installs drivers in a guided way. For many users, this is a huge time saver.

Multimedia codec installation

MX includes an installer that adds multimedia codecs (including proprietary ones) for better video and audio compatibility.

Audio Selector: quickly switch output (like HDMI)

A convenient tool to change audio output without navigating multiple menus.

Conky Manager: customize your desktop

If you use Conky, MX Tools helps manage it. And yes: you can often move it using **Alt + click + drag**.

MX Tweak: change the look of MX easily

With MX Tweak you can quickly modify visual aspects of the desktop. If you want a more modern look or even a "Windows-style" layout, this is a great starting point.

4) SOFTWARE: repositories, mirrors, keys and smart package installation

This section provides powerful tools to manage software safely and cleanly:

- **DEB package installer** (install .deb files easily)
- **GPG key management**
- **Repository Manager** (choose mirrors, manage sources)
- **MX Package Installer** (search and install packages with a guided interface)

This is one of the reasons MX Linux is so appreciated: advanced control with a clean graphical interface.

5) UTILITIES: quick system info and everyday tools

Among the utilities you'll also find:

- **System Info** (fast and detailed hardware info)
- **Format USB** (quick USB formatting, simpler than GParted for basic tasks)
- Other tools depending on your MX version

Why MX Linux is perfect for modern PCs (not just old hardware or Mini PCs)

MX Linux is often recommended for older PCs because it's lightweight. But on modern hardware it offers huge advantages:

- fewer unnecessary background processes
- workstation-level stability
- integrated tools that reduce wasted time
- solid Debian base

If you want a system that **just works** without aggressive updates every few days, MX Linux is a smart choice in 2026.

MX Tools is why MX Linux “wins”

Many distributions are good. But very few offer such a complete and practical suite to manage:

- backup/snapshot
- drivers and codecs
- repositories and packages
- boot repairs
- visual tweaks and setup

MX Tools isn't just a detail it's **the secret weapon** that makes MX Linux fast to manage, easy to maintain and hard to break.